

D640

Giving, Receiving and Incorporating Feedback

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A team lead at a logistics startup that just moved into a new office wants to talk with a coworker who interrupted a client twice during Tuesday's 10 a.m. pricing call. The coworker has been with the company four years. Which opening best follows the SBI model?

- A. "After four years here, you should know better."
- B. "In Tuesday's pricing call, you interrupted the client twice while she explained her budget, and she stopped sharing details after that."
- C. "You're always rude to clients."
- D. "You need to be more respectful."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A manager says: "In yesterday's design review, you presented the budget slides without the updated numbers." Which SBI element is missing?

- A. Nothing; it is complete SBI.
- B. Situation
- C. Behavior
- D. Impact

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A marketing analyst who recently earned a data certificate hears from her manager that the conclusions in her report were not supported by the data. The manager is known for short emails. What is the most effective first response?

- A. Explain why each conclusion is correct.
- B. Say nothing and rewrite the whole report.
- C. Reply with a one-line email to match the manager's style.
- D. Thank the manager and ask for an example of a conclusion that seemed unsupported.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A shift supervisor at a hotel with a rooftop pool saw a front-desk agent calm an angry guest very skillfully on Monday. He plans to mention it at the agent's annual review in November. Occupancy that week was 92%. What is the best advice?

- A. Wait until occupancy drops and there is more time.
- B. Positive feedback should never be given outside formal reviews.
- C. Give specific praise now, while the event is fresh.
- D. Wait for the annual review so the praise is formal.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A graphic designer on a nonprofit's five-person team gets three pieces of feedback on a donation page: the program director wants a brighter color; two of five users in testing could not find the donate button; a board member mentioned the site loads fine on his tablet. What should she act on first?

- A. Change nothing, since the board member said it works.
- B. Make the donate button easier to find.
- C. Change the color first because the director is senior.
- D. Apply every piece of feedback at once, equally.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

During a 360 review at an architecture firm that designs schools, several peers note that a project manager often sighs loudly in meetings — something he had no idea he did. He is known for detailed drawings. In the Johari window, this falls in which area?

- A. Blind
- B. Unknown
- C. Open
- D. Hidden

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which action grows the open area of the Johari window by shrinking the hidden area?

- A.** Asking others for feedback.
- B.** Sharing something about yourself that others don't know.
- C.** Keeping personal information private at all times.
- D.** Quietly observing others.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A U.S.-based product manager, who plays in a weekend soccer league, must give critical feedback to a team member in an office in a high-context culture where saving face matters. The team uses a shared online project board. What approach is most effective?

- A.** Give the feedback privately, with some indirect framing and attention to the relationship.
- B.** Give blunt feedback in the team meeting for transparency.
- C.** Avoid giving any critical feedback.
- D.** Post the critique as a comment on the shared board.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A manager from a high-context culture tells a colleague from a low-context culture, "Perhaps the report could be looked at again at some point." The colleague treats it as optional. What adjustment would help?

- A.** State the specific change needed and the deadline directly.
- B.** Make the message even more indirect.
- C.** Stop giving feedback to that colleague.
- D.** Deliver it in a public meeting for emphasis.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

After losing a client pitch, a sales rep at a solar-panel installer with 40 employees writes down what happened and notes that the client pushed back on the up-front price. The company truck was in the shop that day. In Kolb's cycle, what should come next?

- A. Give the same pitch to the next client right away.
- B. Keep reflecting on the pitch for several more weeks.
- C. Blame the lost deal on the truck being unavailable.
- D. Form a general lesson, such as leading with long-term savings instead of up-front price.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which activity is reflective observation in Kolb's learning cycle?

- A. Giving the presentation.
- B. Deciding on a rule to keep slides under 20 words.
- C. Watching a recording of your presentation and noting where the audience lost interest.
- D. Trying the shorter slides at the next meeting.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A junior accountant at a firm with a casual dress code wants useful feedback from a senior manager she met at a networking event. Which request is most likely to get actionable feedback?

- A. "What do you think of the firm's dress code?"
- B. "Can you confirm my work is perfect?"
- C. "What is one thing I could do differently in my next client summary to make it clearer?"
- D. "Do you have any feedback for me?"

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

A team lead at a logistics startup ~~that just moved into a new office~~ wants to talk with a coworker who interrupted a client twice during Tuesday's 10 a.m. pricing call. ~~The coworker has been with the company four years.~~ Which opening best follows the SBI model?

Target word: best SBI opening **Decides:** It must name situation, behavior, and impact.

A	Camouflage	Tenure does not describe the behavior or its impact.
B	Correct	States the situation, the observable behavior, and the impact.
C	Absolute language	A sweeping label, not a specific behavior.
D	Dropped element	No situation, behavior, or impact.

2. Answer D Concept 1 • transfer

A manager says: "In yesterday's design review, you presented the budget slides without the updated numbers." Which SBI element is missing?

Target word: find the missing element **Decides:** No consequence is stated.

A	Dropped element	Overlooks the missing impact.
B	Confusion set	"Yesterday's design review" is the situation.
C	Adjacent category	Presenting slides without updated numbers is the behavior.
D	Correct	It never says what effect the behavior had.

3. Answer D Concept 2

A marketing analyst ~~who recently earned a data certificate~~ hears from her manager that the conclusions in her report were not supported by the data. ~~The manager is known for short emails.~~ What is the most effective first response?

Target word: first response to criticism **Decides:** She doesn't yet know which conclusions were weak.

A	Inverted operation	Defending before understanding shuts the feedback down.
B	Dropped element	Skips clarifying, so she may fix the wrong things.
C	Camouflage	The manager's email habits don't decide the right response.
D	Correct	Clarifying first turns vague criticism into something she can act on.

4. Answer C Concept 3

A shift supervisor at a hotel ~~with a rooftop pool~~ saw a front-desk agent calm an angry guest very skillfully on Monday. He plans to mention it at the agent's annual review in November. ~~Occupancy that week was 92%.~~ What is the best advice?

Target word: when to give feedback **Decides:** Months would pass between behavior and praise.

A	Camouflage	Occupancy doesn't decide the timing.
B	Absolute language	Feedback works best informally and often.
C	Correct	Timely feedback reinforces the behavior.
D	Inverted operation	Delay weakens the link between behavior and feedback.

5. Answer B Concept 4

A graphic designer ~~on a nonprofit's five-person team~~ gets three pieces of feedback on a donation page: the program director wants a brighter color; two of five users in testing could not find the donate button; ~~a board member mentioned the site loads fine on his tablet~~. What should she act on first?

Target word: which feedback to prioritize **Decides:** Evidence that users can't complete the main goal.

A	Camouflage	Load speed says nothing about finding the button.
B	Correct	Direct evidence that the page is failing its main purpose.
C	Adjacent category	Rank is not evidence; the color request doesn't block donations.
D	Absolute language	Feedback must be weighed, not all treated the same.

6. Answer A Concept 5

During a 360 review at an architecture firm ~~that designs schools~~, several peers note that a project manager often sighs loudly in meetings — something he had no idea he did. ~~He is known for detailed drawings~~. In the Johari window, this falls in which area?

Target word: Johari area **Decides:** Others know it; he didn't.

A	Correct	Known to others, not to self.
B	Adjacent category	Unknown means no one knew; peers did.
C	Confusion set	Open means both he and others knew.
D	Inverted operation	Hidden is known to self but not others.

7. Answer B Concept 5 • transfer

Which action grows the open area of the Johari window by shrinking the hidden area?

Target word: action for the hidden area **Decides:** Hidden shrinks when you share what only you know.

A	Inverted operation	Feedback shrinks the blind area, not the hidden one.
B	Correct	Self-disclosure moves hidden information into the open.
C	Absolute language	That keeps the hidden area as large as it is.
D	Dropped element	Observation alone moves nothing into the open area.

8. Answer A Concept 6

A U.S.-based product manager, ~~who plays in a weekend soccer league~~, must give critical feedback to a team member in an office in a high-context culture where saving face matters. ~~The team uses a shared online project board~~. What approach is most effective?

Target word: culturally fitting delivery **Decides:** High-context, face-saving culture.

A	Correct	Private, softer delivery protects face while still conveying the message.
B	Adjacent category	A low-context norm that causes loss of face here.
C	Absolute language	Adjusting delivery is the goal, not skipping feedback.
D	Camouflage	The board is public to the team, which makes face loss worse.

9. Answer A Concept 6 • transfer

A manager from a high-context culture tells a colleague from a low-context culture, “Perhaps the report could be looked at again at some point.” The colleague treats it as optional. What adjustment would help?

Target word: adjust toward low-context receiver **Decides:** The receiver reads meaning literally.

A	Correct	Low-context listeners rely on explicit words.
B	Inverted operation	Moves further from what this receiver needs.
C	Absolute language	The fix is clearer delivery, not silence.
D	Confusion set	Setting is not the problem; explicitness is.

10. Answer D Concept 7

After losing a client pitch, a sales rep at a solar-panel installer ~~with 40 employees~~ writes down what happened and notes that the client pushed back on the up-front price. ~~The company truck was in the shop that day.~~ In Kolb’s cycle, what should come next?

Target word: next Kolb stage **Decides:** Experience and reflection are done.

A	Dropped element	Skips forming a lesson to test.
B	Confusion set	Stays in the reflection stage instead of moving forward.
C	Camouflage	The truck did not decide the client’s price concern.
D	Correct	Abstract conceptualization follows reflective observation.

11. Answer C Concept 7 • transfer

Which activity is reflective observation in Kolb’s learning cycle?

Target word: identify the stage **Decides:** Reviewing and noticing what happened.

A	Confusion set	That is concrete experience.
B	Adjacent category	Drawing a rule is abstract conceptualization.
C	Correct	Looking back at the experience is reflective observation.
D	Inverted operation	That is active experimentation, the last stage.

12. Answer C Concept 8

A junior accountant at a firm ~~with a casual dress code~~ wants useful feedback from a senior manager ~~she met at a networking event~~. Which request is most likely to get actionable feedback?

Target word: best way to ask **Decides:** Specific and forward-looking.

A	Camouflage	Unrelated to her performance.
B	Absolute language	Invites reassurance, not improvement.
C	Correct	Specific, limited, and focused on a next action.
D	Dropped element	Too vague to get a useful answer.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	6	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	5	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	6	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	7	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	5	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	7	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	SBI feedback model	Good feedback names the Situation, the specific observable Behavior, and its Impact — not personality.	Labeling the person (“you’re rude”) instead of describing behavior.	Choosing the best way to open a feedback conversation.
2	Receiving feedback	Listen, thank, and ask clarifying questions before responding or deciding what to change.	Defending yourself point by point right away.	Someone has just received criticism.
3	Timeliness	Feedback, positive or corrective, works best soon after the event while details are fresh.	Saving it for the annual review.	A delay between the behavior and the planned feedback.
4	Incorporating feedback	Weigh feedback by evidence and impact on the goal, then act on the highest-value items first.	Obedying the most senior voice or trying to do everything at once.	Several pieces of feedback that conflict or compete.
5	Johari window	Blind = known to others, not self (shrunk by asking for feedback); hidden = known to self, not others (shrunk by self-disclosure).	Mixing up blind and hidden.	Who knows the information: self, others, or both.
6	Feedback across cultures	In high-context, face-saving cultures, give critical feedback privately and with more indirect framing; with low-context colleagues, be explicit.	Using one direct, public style everywhere.	Mention of culture, face-saving, or indirect messages.
7	Reflection as self-feedback (Kolb)	Kolb’s cycle: concrete experience → reflective observation → abstract conceptualization (the lesson) → active experimentation.	Repeating the experience without drawing a lesson.	Someone has just reviewed what happened.
8	Asking for feedback	Specific, forward-looking requests get actionable feedback.	Asking “Any feedback?” and getting nothing useful.	Choosing how to phrase a request for feedback.

Course scope (public description): Giving, Receiving, and Incorporating Feedback introduces students to the skills and strategies used to successfully receive feedback, iterate based on feedback, and provide constructive feedback to others. This course explores personal and professional settings in different contexts, including culturally complex or diverse settings. Students will engage with their peers as they are introduced to self-assessment and reflection as forms of feedback that can help them explore personal interests and preferences as well as professional relationships and networks.